

Constitution of the Software Acceleration Team

Kennesaw State University

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Article I – Name

Section 1 – Organization Name

The name of this organization shall be the Software Acceleration Team, hereafter referred to in this document as SwAT.

Article II – Purpose or Mission Statement

Section 1 – Mission and Objectives

The purpose of this organization shall be to give students in computing and related fields (including computer science, software engineering, cybersecurity, game design, and quantitative finance) a space to gain practical, real-world engineering experience beyond the classroom. SwAT exists to:

- a. organize ongoing, longer-form team projects in which members practice professional software engineering workflows, including version control, code review, DevOps practices, and technical documentation;
- b. develop members into strong candidates for competitive roles through regular presentations in which they explain and defend their technical decisions: languages, architecture, tools, libraries, version control practices, and results;
- c. educate members through knowledge sessions on tools, libraries, platforms, and emerging technologies; and
- d. connect members with industry and with other Kennesaw State University organizations through real projects, partnerships, and client work.

Article III – Affiliations

Section 1 – Kennesaw State University

- i. This organization is a Registered Student Organization (RSO) at Kennesaw State University, but is not part of the University itself.
- ii. In all correspondence and publications, it may refer to itself as an organization at Kennesaw State University, but not as part of Kennesaw State University itself.
- iii. Software Acceleration Team accepts full financial and production responsibility for all activities it sponsors.
- iv. Software Acceleration Team agrees to abide by all pertinent Kennesaw State University policies and regulations, including the most current RSO Manual and Student Codes of Conduct. Where Kennesaw State University policies and regulations and those of SWAT differ, the policies and regulations of Kennesaw State University will take precedence.
- v. Software Acceleration Team recognizes and understands that the University assumes no legal liability for the actions of the organization.

Section 2 – External Affiliations

SwAT is not currently affiliated with any state or national non-student entity.

Article IV – Membership

Section 1 – Eligibility

This organization is open to all KSU students, regardless of major, who are in good standing with the University, as that term is defined in Article II, Section 1 of the bylaws. Students must be enrolled in at least one (1) credit hour at Kennesaw State University to be considered a member. Non-KSU students may participate in and be affiliated with the organization, but will not be recognized as full members with voting rights.

Section 2 – Active Membership

Active members of SwAT are required, each semester, to attend at least fifty percent (50%) of general meetings and to either contribute to an active project team or deliver at least one presentation or knowledge session. SwAT does not charge membership dues.

Section 3 – Privileges and Voting

Active members are entitled to vote in elections and on organization business, to hold officer positions, to serve on and lead committees, to join and lead project teams, and to access organization resources and events. Each member has one vote, no matter how many officer, committee, or project roles the member holds. A candidate for office may vote in their own election.

Section 4 – Removal of Members

A member may be removed for conduct that materially harms the organization or for repeated failure to meet the responsibilities of membership. Removal requires written notice to the member, an opportunity for the member to respond before the Executive Board, and a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Executive Board. A removed member may appeal to the general membership, where a majority vote of active members present, quorum having been established, is final.

Section 5 – Alumni

Alumni of SwAT are former active members who have graduated from Kennesaw State University. Alumni may continue to participate in organization events and activities, but do not have voting rights or officer eligibility. They are encouraged to mentor current members, to serve on Defended Review panels, and to connect members with industry.

"Please note that RSOs cannot hold members accountable to the Student Codes of Conduct, Title IX, or any other campus policies. Any such incidents shall be reported to the appropriate University entity so that the appropriate adjudication process may occur."

Article V – Officers or Executive Board

Section 1 – Officers and Duties

The officers of this organization, who together constitute the Executive Board, shall be the President, Vice President, Treasurer, Secretary, Director of Projects, and Director of Outreach.

- a. **President.** The President shall be responsible for leading all organization meetings, monitoring the performance of all other officers, representing the organization to the University and external parties, and serving as the chief executive officer. The President shall be listed as President in Owl Life.
- b. **Vice President.** The Vice President shall assume all responsibilities of the President in the case of the President's absence, shall assist the President in the performance of their duties, and shall serve as the Reservation Delegate for the organization in Owl Life, with authority to make space reservations on behalf of the organization.
- c. **Treasurer.** The Treasurer shall be responsible for all financial activity of the organization, including maintaining an accurate balance of the organization's finances, managing any budget or funding, and serving as a fiduciary for the organization. The Treasurer shall be listed as Treasurer in Owl Life.
- d. **Secretary.** The Secretary shall be responsible for taking minutes at all organization meetings, dispatching official correspondence, notifying members of meetings, and maintaining organization documents, records, and communication channels.
- e. **Director of Projects.** The Director of Projects shall oversee the project lifecycle (pitch, scoping, build sprints, defended review, and retrospective), shall appoint and support project leads, and shall maintain the organization's engineering standards, including repositories, documentation, and version control practices.
- f. **Director of Outreach.** The Director of Outreach shall develop and manage relationships with industry partners and with other Kennesaw State University organizations,

shall coordinate guest reviewers and external clients, and shall manage external-facing communication in coordination with the Secretary.

Section 2 – Eligibility and Concurrent Roles

To be eligible to run for office, a candidate must have been an active member of the organization for at least one (1) semester prior to the election and must be in good standing with the University. A member may hold more than one officer position, and may hold officer, committee, and project roles at the same time. The offices of President and Treasurer shall not be held by the same member. The Executive Board shall include at least four (4) distinct members.

Section 3 – Terms

Officers shall serve a term of one (1) year, beginning at the formal transition of officers following elections. Elections shall be held before the expiration of the current officers' terms so that a transition period is preserved.

Section 4 – Removal of Officers

An officer may be removed for failure to perform the duties of their office or for conduct that materially harms the organization. Removal requires a petition signed by at least one-third ($1/3$) of active members or a motion by the Executive Board, written notice to the officer, an opportunity for the officer to respond, and a two-thirds ($2/3$) vote of the active members present, quorum having been established.

Article VI – Elections

Section 1 – Timeline

Election of officers shall be held annually in April. The Secretary shall announce the election, the call for candidates, and the slate of candidates to the membership at least two (2) weeks in advance. Results shall be announced at the conclusion of the election meeting, and the

formal transition of officers shall be completed within two (2) weeks of the election. This process shall be democratic, as required by the RSO Manual.

Section 2 – Vacancies

Should an office become vacant mid-term, the Executive Board shall appoint an interim officer, subject to ratification by a majority vote of active members present at the next regular meeting. A vacancy in the office of President shall be filled by the Vice President for the remainder of the term.

Section 3 – Voting Procedures

Elections shall be conducted by secret ballot. A candidate shall be elected by a simple majority of active members voting. If no candidate for an office receives a majority, a runoff shall be held between the two candidates receiving the most votes.

Article VII – Meetings

Section 1 – Schedule and Notice

Regular meetings shall be held weekly during the fall and spring semesters. The President, or a majority of the Executive Board, may call a special meeting. The Secretary shall publish the regular meeting schedule at the start of each semester and shall notify members of any special meeting, via e-mail, no later than five (5) business days in advance of the meeting.

Section 2 – Quorum

Quorum shall consist of a majority (more than fifty percent) of active voting members and must be present to conduct the business of the organization.

Section 3 – Governing Rules

The most recent edition of *Robert's Rules of Order* shall govern the meetings of this organization within the requirements of this constitution and any bylaws adopted by the membership.

Article VIII – Advisors

Section 1 – Responsibilities

There shall be at least one (1) full-time Kennesaw State University faculty or staff member who shall serve as an advisor to the organization. The advisor shall provide guidance and institutional continuity, assist with required University paperwork, and attend meetings and events when able. Consistent with the RSO Manual, the advisor serves as a guide and may not make decisions on behalf of the organization.

Section 2 – Selection and Term

The advisor shall be selected by the Executive Board and confirmed annually by a majority vote of active members. Should a change of advisor become necessary, a new advisor may be appointed by the same process.

Article IX – Committees

Section 1 – Standing Committees

The organization may establish standing committees to carry out its work, including but not limited to a Projects Committee, an Outreach Committee, and an Events Committee. Each committee shall operate under the direction of the relevant officer and shall report to the Executive Board.

Section 2 – Committee Membership

Committee members shall be appointed by the officer responsible for that committee, with the approval of the Executive Board, or active members may volunteer to serve. All active members are encouraged to serve on at least one committee.

Article X – Finances

Section 1 – Dues

The organization shall not collect mandatory membership dues. Funding may instead be sought through University allocations, sponsorships, and fundraising activities consistent with University policy.

Section 2 – Accounting

The Treasurer shall maintain accurate records of all funds received and expended and shall report the organization’s financial status to the membership upon request. All expenditures shall be reviewed by the Executive Board, and financial records shall be available to the advisor to ensure transparency and accountability.

Article XI – Intellectual Property

Section 1 – Ownership

Members retain full ownership of the intellectual property they create, including all copyright, patent, and licensing rights. SwAT claims no ownership of any work created by its members. Where a work has multiple contributors, those contributors hold it jointly and are responsible for settling ownership, licensing, and any proceeds among themselves.

Section 2 – License to SwAT

As a condition of participating in a SwAT project team, each contributor grants SwAT a non-exclusive, perpetual, irrevocable, royalty-free, worldwide license to host, use, reproduce, modify, maintain, continue, display, and distribute their contributions to that project, and to use the project and the contributor’s name in demonstrations, presentations, recruiting, and promotional material. This license is not a transfer of ownership. It exists so that the organization can keep a project alive after its original contributors graduate or move on.

Section 3 – Custody of Repositories

Project repositories shall be hosted in an organization-controlled account. SwAT shall maintain administrative control of those repositories so that no single member may unilaterally delete a project, make it private, or transfer it out of the organization. Deletion, transfer, or restriction of a project repository requires the review of a panel as defined in the bylaws.

Section 4 – Right to Fork and Leave

Any contributor may fork, clone, republish, relicense their own contributions, or commercialize a SwAT project at any time, without the permission of SwAT and without any fee, buyout, royalty, or revenue share owed to SwAT. SwAT shall not condition membership, advancement, or access to organization resources on the surrender of a member's intellectual property.

Section 5 – Client Work and University Policy

Work performed for an external client or sponsor is governed by a written agreement reviewed by the advisor before work begins, and the terms of that agreement supersede Sections 1 through 4 for that project. Nothing in this Article shall be construed to override the intellectual property policies of Kennesaw State University or the Board of Regents of the University System of Georgia, which take precedence where they apply.

Article XII – Constitutional Amendments

Section 1 – Amendment Process

This constitution may be amended by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the active members present at any regular meeting of the organization, quorum having been established. Proposed amendments must be submitted in writing and distributed to the membership at least one (1) regular meeting in advance of the vote. Amendments take effect immediately upon passage unless the amendment specifies otherwise.

Article XIII – Non-Discrimination Policy

Section 1 – Statement

Membership and all privileges, including voting and officer positions, must be extended to all students without regard to race, color, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, ethnicity or national origin, religion, age, genetic information, disability, or veteran status. Membership and all privileges, including voting and officer positions, must be extended to all students as stated in the Kennesaw State University Non-Discrimination Statement. Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 protects people from discrimination based on race, color or national origin in programs or activities that receive Federal financial assistance. Title IX states that: No person in the United States shall, on the basis of sex, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any education program or activity receiving Federal financial assistance.

Article XIV – Bylaws

Section 1 – Authority of the Bylaws

The organization may adopt bylaws to govern detailed or secondary policies not contained in this constitution. Such bylaws shall carry the authority of the organization, provided they do not conflict with this constitution.

Section 2 – Adoption and Amendment

Bylaws may be adopted or amended by a majority vote of the active members present at any regular meeting, quorum having been established, provided the proposed change has been distributed to the membership at least one (1) regular meeting in advance.

Article XV – Dissolution

Section 1 – Dissolution Procedure

The organization may be dissolved by a two-thirds ($2/3$) vote of the active membership, quorum having been established, at a meeting for which the proposed dissolution was announced at least two (2) weeks in advance. Upon dissolution, the organization shall settle any outstanding debts, and any remaining property, funds, accounts, and online or social media assets shall be transferred to the Kennesaw State University Department of Student Affairs or donated to a charitable or educational entity as determined by the Executive Board in consultation with the advisor.